

Autism in Tech



Dennie Declercq // Virtual Azure Community Day 2020 🦋

Content

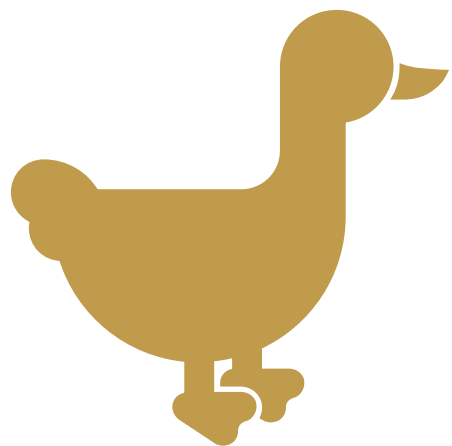
- I am different
- The Autistic Brain
- Autism in Tech
 - Executive Functioning in Tech
 - Central Coherence in Tech
 - ToM in Tech
 - Co-Morbid in Tech
- What worked for me?



Who am I?

- Dennie Declercq
- DDSoft
- President / Developer
- @DennieDeclercq
- #DreamingIsBelieving





I am different

Autistic

- Different since I was a child
- Autism diagnose at age of 13
- No university college



Without a paid job

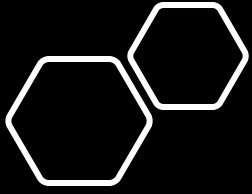
- 2008 – 2011: Tried some jobs
- No science degree
- Fabric for people with disabilities
- Tech / development in after hours
- Ended on a sickness benefit



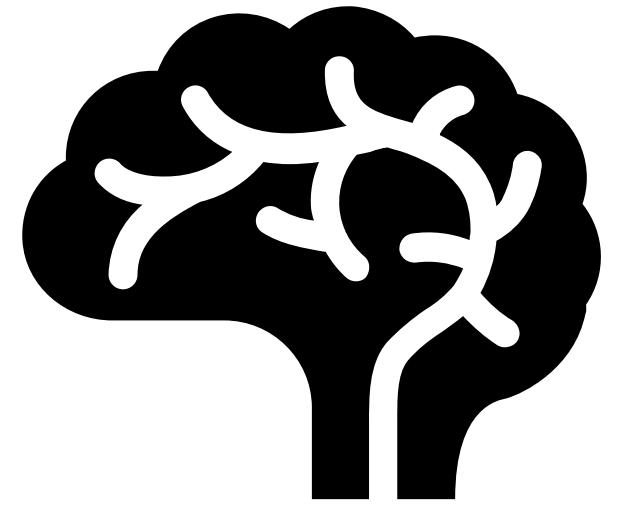
A tech lover

- Very passionate
- Fanatic pro Microsoft
- Windows Mobile
- Why did Windows Phone die?
- Windows 3.1 → 10
- VB6 → C#





Autistic Brain





Theory of Mind

- Understanding the WHY
- Seeing which behavior causes which outcome.
- Seeing logical steps



Executive Functioning

- Everything that you need in daily living or in a working environment
- Examples:
 - Planning a timeslot
 - Planning what to wear at this conference
 - Planning which sessions you want to see



Central Coherence

- Coherence of situations, things, tasks, words
- Seeing the global picture





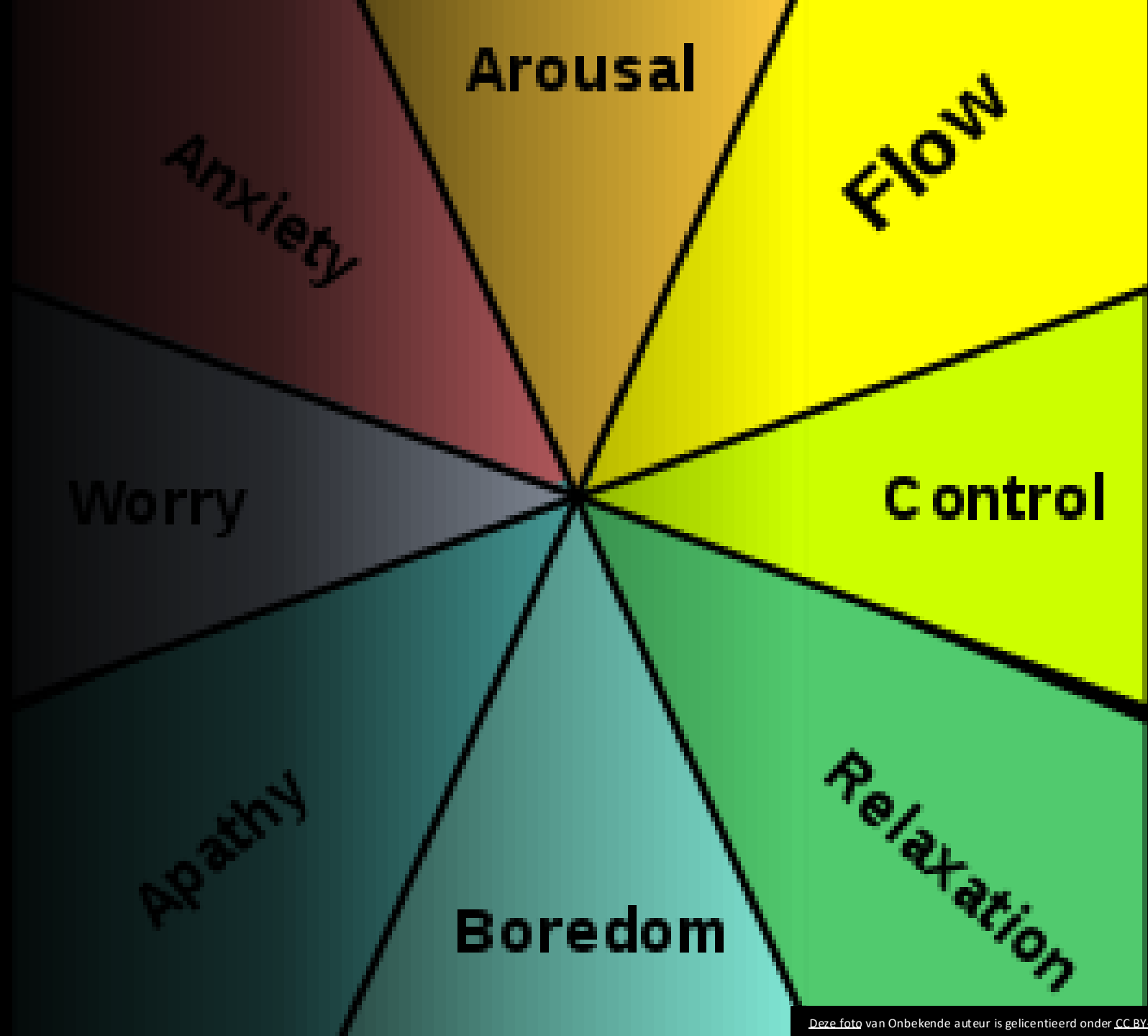
Context Blindness

- Understanding the context of something
- ‘One incentive has one meaning’
- Problems with ‘use of the same words for other meanings’



Co-morbid

- Extra psychological problems
 - Extra stress
 - Anxiety
 - Depression
 - ADHD





Autism in Tech



Executive functioning
in tech



Different energy
and new
technologies



Code Style

- P.w. Autism think straight forward
 - My way of the highway
 - Can be sure they use the best classes, procedures
- Difficult to change code style
 - New possibilities in C#
 - Difficult to adapt some patterns.

```
private bool CheckInternetConnection()  
{  
    //Xamarin.Essentials: Connectivity  
    var connection = Connectivity.NetworkAccess.InternetAvailable;  
    if(connection == NetworkAccess.InternetAvailable)  
    {  
        NoConnectionButton.IsVisible = false;  
        return true;  
    }  
    else  
    {  
        NoConnectionButton.IsVisible = true;  
        return false;  
    }  
}
```

Code patterns





Structure

- Day Structure
 - Huge change of different day structure
 - More breaks during day
- Project timeframe

STRUCTURE





Central Coherence in Tech



Covid19 & Virtual conferences



Cross – software solutions

Architecture style

N-tier

Microservices

Web-queue-
worker

Event driven

Big Compute

Big Data

Technology choices

Compute

Data stores

Messaging

Application architecture

Reference
architectures

Design
principles

Design
patterns

Best
practices

Microsoft Azure Well-Architected Framework

Security

Scalability

Resiliency

DevOps

Cost

Cloud patterns

Colors and IDE's

Go Debug Terminal Help

Blazor > Bethanys > 02 > demos > Demo

BethanysPieShopHRM.Server.Pages

*, Microsoft.AspNetCore.Mvc.T

ml>

en">

arset="utf-8" />

me="viewport" content="width=de

BethanysPieShopHRM.Server</title

ef="~/ " />

l="stylesheet" href="css/bootst

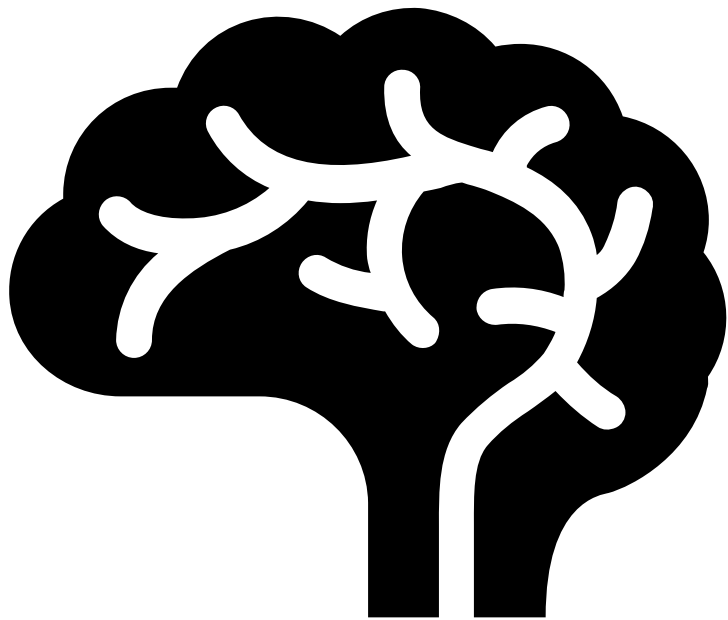
ef="css/site.css" rel="styleshe

src="https://kit.fontawesome.com



Conferences

- Attend each conference / Meetup
- Wishlist of speakers
- Important to belong with somebody



ToM in Tech

Being fanatic &
user groups and
conferences

- Can be an issue
- More difficult at
conferences
 - Variety of
topics /
speakers





User groups & conferences and different communication

- Talking too much or too little
- Problems with eye contact
- Different non-verbal communication
 - Example: being excited but can't show

Being fanatic in tech

- Pro Microsoft / Apple / Linux?
- Difficult to use both
- C# / JavaScript
 - Me: so happy with Blazor 😊
- ASP.NET or PHP
- Biased in apps / libraries



Stack Exchange Q&A communities are different. Here's how:



Expert communities.

Each of our 174 communities is built by people passionate about a focused topic.



The right answer. Right on top.

Experts like you can vote on posts, so the most helpful answers are easy to find.



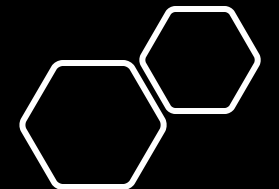
Share knowledge. Earn trust.

Earn reputation and additional privileges for posts others find helpful.

[Learn more](#)

Forums and communication

- Difficult if you are fanatic
- Forum expect knowledge and DIY
- Was difficult in the beginning





DM's and communication

Big mismatch in communication



Code reviews

Difficult if you have a different
code style

GitHub | DDGuard

[0 Open](#) ▼ | [Create New](#)



There aren't any open pull requests

Pull requests let you tell others
about changes you've pushed to a
repository on GitHub

To get started you can [create a pull request](#)



Co-Morbid in Tech

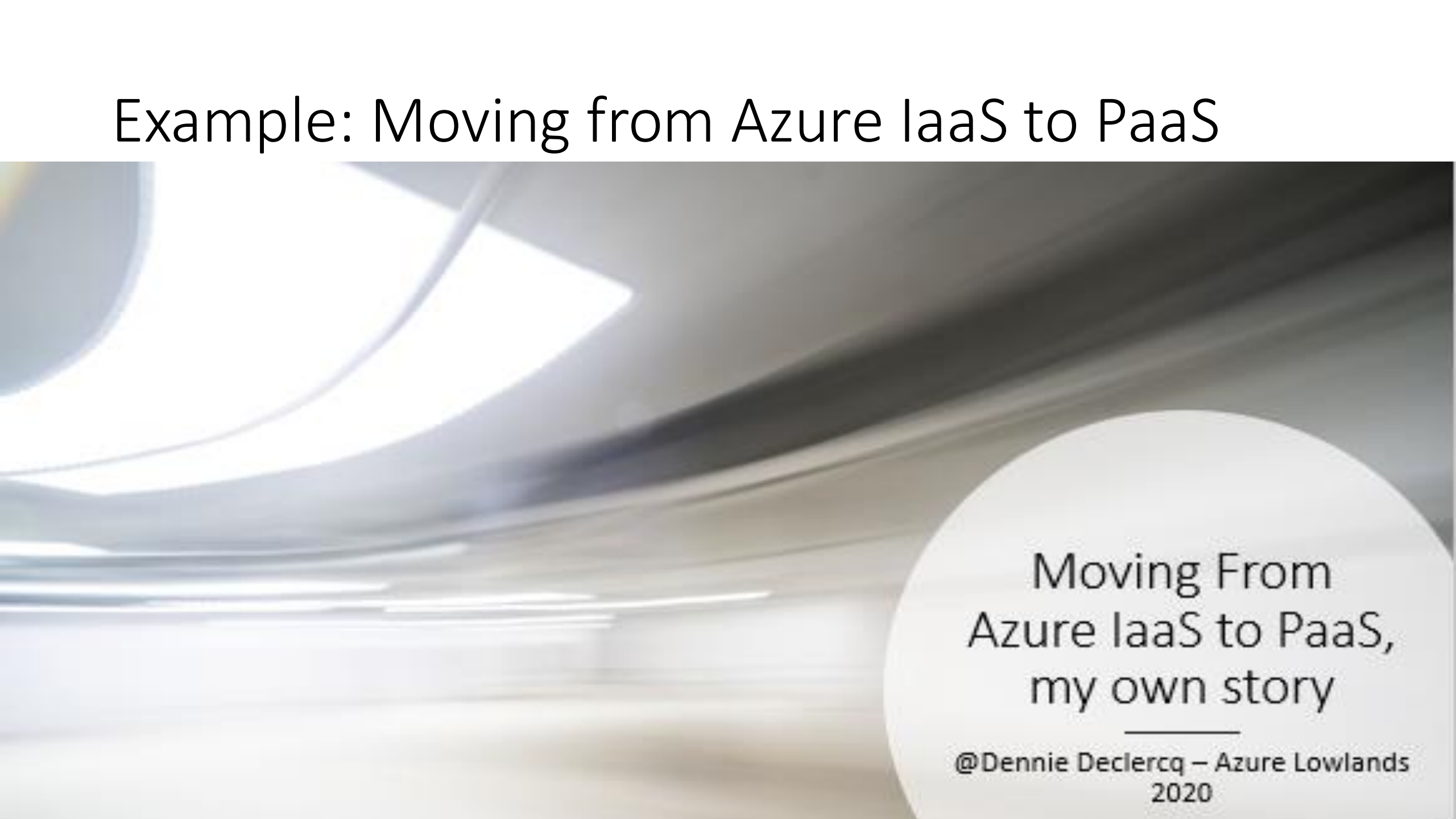


Working on updates
11% complete
Don't turn off your computer

Anxiety in tech

- Being afraid to change from tool stack
- Windows update
- Being afraid to ask questions in fora
- Being afraid to use public transport (too little time in the community)
- Cloud changes (Azure IaaS to PaaS)
- Being afraid of losing friends & Being fanatic
- Afraid of losing your job & own vision

Example: Moving from Azure IaaS to PaaS



Moving From
Azure IaaS to PaaS,
my own story

@Dennie Declercq – Azure Lowlands
2020

Example:
Xamarin.Forms



NETStandard.Library v2.0.3

A set of standard .NET A...



Xamarin.Essentials by v1.2.0

Xamarin.Essentials: a kit... v1.3.1



Xamarin.Forms v4.1.0.581479

Build native UIs f... v4.4.0.991537

What worked for me?

Welcome back, Dennie Declercq

Master core concepts at your speed and on your schedule. Whether you've got 15 minutes or an hour, you can develop practical skills through interactive modules and paths.



LEARNING PATHS

Learn on your own schedule

Explore a topic in-depth through guided paths or

CERTIFICATIONS

Become Microsoft certified

Jump-start your career and demonstrate your

LEARN TV

Watch live and recorded events

View streaming technical content about Microsoft products from the experts that build

Code style

- Community Leaders
- Interest
- Microsoft Learn
- Conference talks

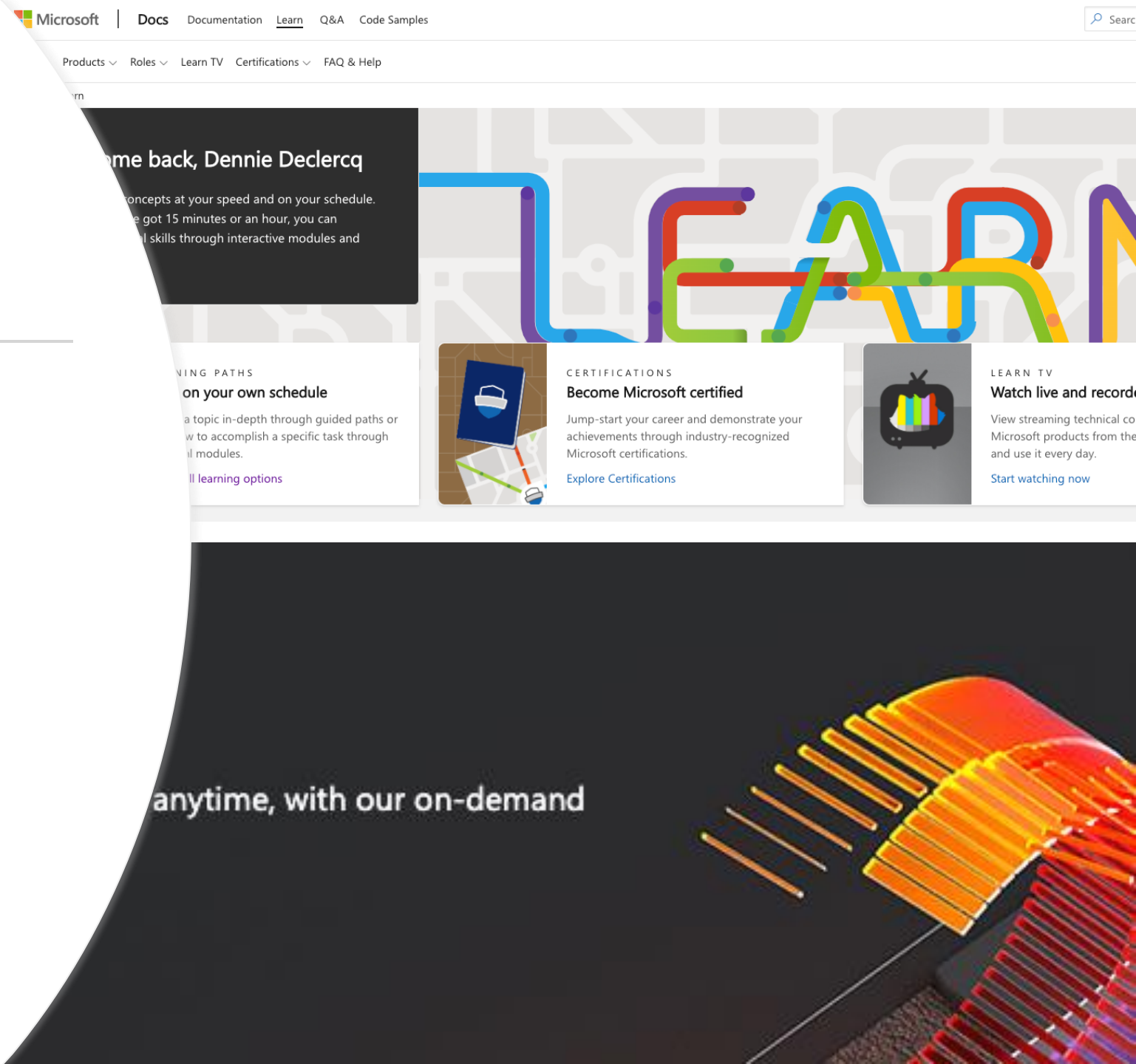
Colors

- The need and the urge
- The broad possibilities



New Technologies

- Focussing on interest
- The love of conferences
- The joy of being inspired
- Microsoft Learn





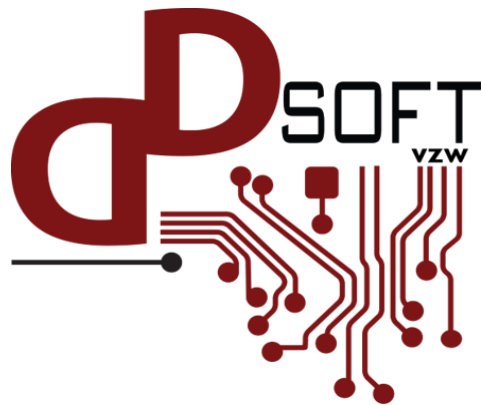
Windows / Mac

- The need and the urge
- Web versions look the same!
- Thank Microsoft for Edge

Wrap up

Thanks! Q&A

- Dennie Declercq
- @DennieDeclercq
- #DreamingIsBelieving
- dennie@ddsoft.be



Proudly sponsored by

